

# Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Micro-Project

PHASE 3 | PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

### 3. Project Design Phase

#### 3.1 Solution Architecture Overview

The solution has three logical layers: a **Presentation layer** (the Service Catalog item "Standard Laptop" that the requester interacts with), an **Automation layer** (the "Standard Laptop task" Flow built in Flow Designer), and a **Fulfillment layer** (the Catalog Task automatically routed to the Hardware assignment group). The Process Engine on the catalog item is the bridge that connects the Presentation layer to the Automation layer.

**End-to-end flow:** User orders "Standard Laptop" from Service Catalog → Request (REQ) & Requested Item (RITM) created → Approver approves the RITM → Flow trigger ("Service Catalog") fires → "Create Catalog Task" action runs → Catalog Task (sc\_task) created, pre-filled, and assigned to Hardware.

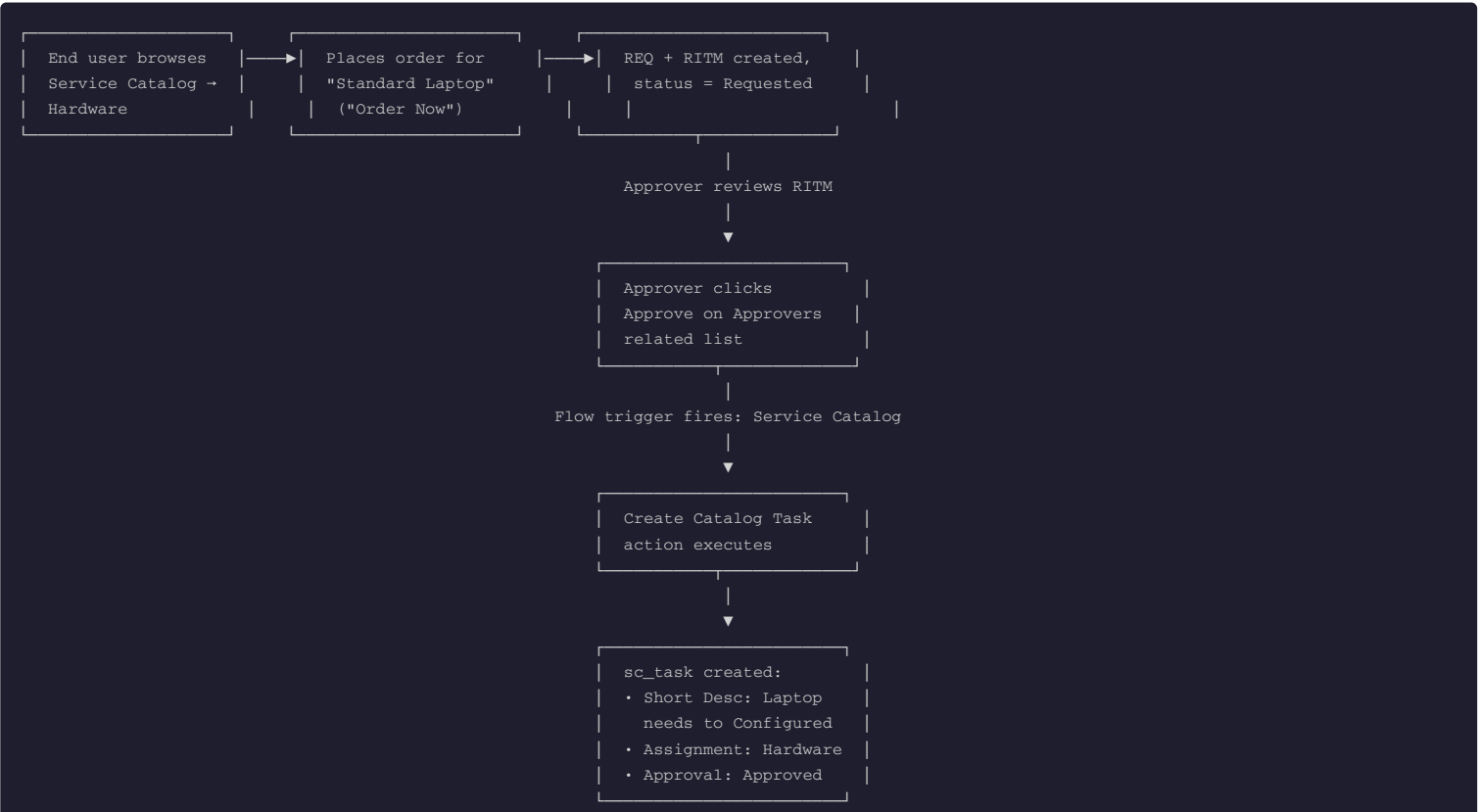
#### 3.2 Flow Design — "Standard Laptop task"

| Property               | Value                                                       |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Flow name              | Standard Laptop task                                        |
| Application            | Global                                                      |
| Run As                 | System User                                                 |
| Trigger                | Service Catalog                                             |
| Action                 | Create Catalog Task                                         |
| Table (auto-populated) | Catalog Task [sc_task]                                      |
| Requested Item         | Trigger → Requested Item (dragged/mapped from trigger data) |

#### 3.3 Field Mapping Design (Create Catalog Task action)

| Field                | Value Set by Flow                  |
|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| Short Description    | Laptop needs to Configured         |
| Description          | Laptop needs to Configured         |
| Assignment group     | Hardware                           |
| Approval             | Approved                           |
| Requested Item       | Trigger's Requested Item record    |
| All remaining fields | Left as default (system-generated) |

#### 3.4 Process Flow Diagram



### 3.5 Catalog Item Design — Process Engine Binding

The "Standard Laptop" catalog item's **Process Engine** tab has three mutually exclusive automation slots: *Flow*, *Workflow*, and *Execution Plan*. The design specifies that any legacy automation must be cleared from these slots, and the `Flow` field must be set to **Standard Laptop task**, ensuring the new Flow is the single source of fulfillment automation for this item.

### 3.6 Milestone-to-Design Mapping

| Milestone                     | Design Element                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Milestone 1 — Flow            | Build the "Standard Laptop task" Flow: trigger + Create Catalog Task action with field mapping |
| Milestone 2 — Flow assignment | Bind the Flow to the "Standard Laptop" catalog item's Process Engine                           |
| Milestone 3 — Service Catalog | End-to-end order placement, approval, and verification of the generated Catalog Task           |

### 3.7 UI / Interaction Design

- No custom UI is built — the standard Service Catalog item page, Request/Requested Item forms, and Catalog Task form are used as-is, keeping the project strictly automation-focused.
- Approval is actioned through the standard right-click context menu on the Approvers related list (Approve/Reject), requiring no custom UI Action.
- Verification is performed by opening the Requested Item's "Catalog Tasks" related list and inspecting the auto-created record.

### 3.8 Design Rationale

Binding automation to the Service Catalog trigger and the catalog item's native Process Engine (rather than a custom Business Rule) keeps the solution fully within ServiceNow's supported, low-code catalog-fulfillment model — making it easy to audit, easy to hand over to the Hardware team, and easy to extend to other standard catalog items later.